



YOU ARE **31 WEEKS EXACTLY**
63 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

One leg is shown here crossed over the other. Your baby can still stretch the legs out fully and even curl up in such a way that the feet can rest on top of the head: just because you're kicked on one side doesn't mean that the head will be on the other.

“Epidural is a common form of pain-relief during labor and may be an option for you if you have a low pain threshold.”

Many women have decided that they want a pain-free delivery with an [epidural](#) even before they go into labor. It's good to know, however, that labor has to be well established before you can have an epidural, so you'll still experience some painful contractions. Epidurals generally work well, but sometimes the block isn't complete or is more effective on one side than the other. Some women decide to have an epidural because they know they're unlikely to cope well with labor pain. Many women start off saying that they don't want an epidural and change their minds halfway through—if it's your first pregnancy, you can't possibly know how you'll feel.

A scheduled [Cesarean](#) is one that is planned and generally performed for medical reasons—for example, because of a [low-lying placenta](#).

Some women will choose to give birth by Cesarean without having any medical reasons for surgery, but this is rare. It's important to discuss any concerns you have about your plan for delivery with your obstetrician.

TOCOPHOBIA

This condition is an intense fear or dread of childbirth. There are two types: primary [tocophobia](#) predates pregnancy and can start as early as adolescence; secondary [tocophobia](#) is associated with an earlier traumatic experience in childbirth. This fear can manifest itself as nightmares, intense anxiety, or panic attacks.

If you have [tocophobia](#), your doctor will refer you to a consultant obstetrician who deals in mental health issues, or you may be referred directly to a psychologist to discuss your fears. Some experts believe that hypnotherapy can help to tackle any subconscious fears of childbirth. An elective [cesarean](#) may be recommended if your fear of having a vaginal birth cannot be overcome.

HAVING SEX IN LATE PREGNANCY
